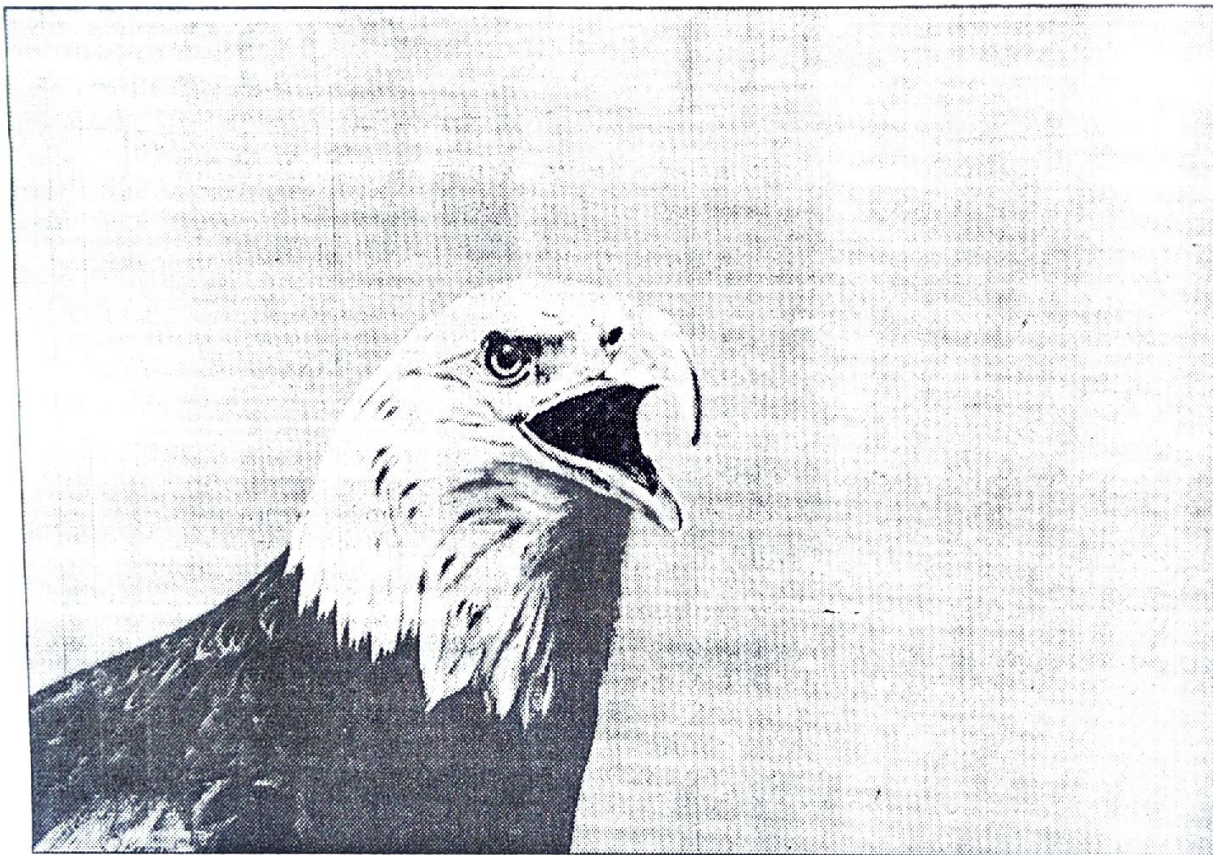




Portraits: Kernersville artist John Kreger's charcoal portraits of Sir Raleigh, the Raptor Center's male bald eagle (above), and Dumbo, a barred owl (below), can be seen at the center Sunday.

Wildlife art exhibit the first for Raptor Center's new hall

By PAT BORDEN GUBBINS
Staff Writer

A one-day wildlife art show on

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A one-day wildlife art show on Sunday will inaugurate use of the Carolina Raptor Center's new exhibit hall.

Nine artists, including several from Charlotte, will display their work from 10 a.m. to 5 p.m. The artists will be at the Raptor Center, located in Latta Plantation Park, from 1 to 5 p.m. to talk to visitors and sell their work.

"This is the very first thing we will have done in the new exhibit hall," said director Pat Marcum. "These are all first-class artists who do beautiful work. We hope to have exhibits of up to 20 artists and perhaps will do some outdoors."

The exhibit will feature the works of:

- Scott Wesson, a singer, guitarist and songwriter from High Point who has produced a 50-minute wildlife video. He will be selling copies of his video, "The Spirit of Nature."

- Pete Lupo of Greensboro, a national champion wildlife wood carver.

- Danny O'Driscoll of Batesburg, S.C., who works with acrylic and airbrush.

- Becky Rickenbaker of Gilbert, S.C., the S.C. Wildlife Foundation Artist of the Year, who uses acrylics and painted a collector's bald eagle poster for the Raptor Center.

- Steven Hein of Georgia, who works in gouache and is a falconer as well as a wildlife artist.

- Susan Sgouros of Charlotte, whose medium is colored pencils.

- Shelley Brunken of Alabama, who works with scratch board.

- John Kreger of Kernersville,

who does black and white works in charcoal featuring the birds being rehabilitated at the Raptor Center.

- Eric Vaughn of Charlotte, who is a free-lance wildlife photographer.

The artists will donate 30% of their sales to the Raptor Center, which dedicated its new building May 24. The center, which costs about \$400 a day to operate,

depends on donations from the public.

Want to go?

The Carolina Raptor Center, 6000 Sample Rd. in Latta Plantation Park, is open 10 a.m. to 5 p.m. Tuesday through Sunday. For details, call 875-6521, 9 a.m. to 5 p.m.



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